prices for many products. The extent of misalignment is substantial, leading to *large untargeted subsidies*. Several initiatives have been taken by the GoI for rationalizing the energy prices in different sectors –

- The Integrated Energy Policy has outlined the broad contours of the pricing system for coal. The *pricing of coal* is done now on gross calorific value (GCV) basis with effect from 31 January 2012, replacing the earlier system of pricing on the basis of useful heat value (UHV) which takes into account the heat trapped in ash content also, besides the heat value of carbon content. The revision in the GCV is likely to increase the prices of domestic coal to some extent, but this is a desirable adjustment because domestic thermal coal, adjusted for quality differences, continues to be underpriced.
- In case of petroleum products pricing, the government dismantled the Administered Pricing Mechanism in 2002. This decision, however, was not fully implemented and domestic pass through of global price increases remained low for petrol, diesel, kerosene, and LPG – in June 2010, the government announced that the *price of petrol was fully deregulated* and the oil companies were free to fix it periodically.
- In *January 2013*, the government announced the new roadmap providing for a gradual price increase for reducing *diesel under-recoveries*.
- Admissibility of subsidized number of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) cylinders and prices of LPG have also recently been revised. Pricing of gas is presently done under the New Exploration Licensing Policy (NELP). The government provides the operator freedom to sell the gas produced from the NELP blocks at a market-determined price, subject to the approval of pricing formula. The government is reviewing pricing under the PSC (price sharing contract) to clarify the extent to which producers will have the freedom to market the gas.

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